

Wildcats get a scare

Special to The Citizen

EL PASO — Texas-El Paso's Miners came close yesterday.

But since close only counts in horseshoes, darts and hand grenades, that's the only satisfaction the Miners got out of an 11-inning, 15-12 loss to Arizona's Wildcats.

Coach Jerry Kindall's Cats, fighting for survival in the Western Athletic Conference Southern Division baseball race, nearly suffered disaster in the opener of a three-game series.

The set was to conclude today with a doubleheader here beginning at noon (Tucson time). The first game was scheduled for seven innings and the second for nine.

UA kept alive its faint hopes for a shot at the WAC title when freshman catcher Bob Woodside slammed a three-

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run double in the top of the 11th.

UA, now 35-9-1 overall, moved to 10-3 in the WAC race and clinched second place, but remained three games behind Arizona State, which won last night at Albuquerque against New Mexico, 6-1.

UTEP, 15-24 overall, lost its 13th straight Southern Division game of the season against no victories.

Arizona has now defeated coach Andy Cohen's Miners in all 19 appearances at Dudley Field here — and yesterday's

contest was just as wacky as the previous 18. Something strange always happens at Dudley Field.

The Wildcats spotted the Miners a 3-0 lead when Glenn Villarreal smacked a three-run home run off UA starter Craig Gioia in the first inning.

After rallying for a pair of runs in the second, the Arizonans fell behind by 6-2 when the Miners ripped Gioia for three more runs in the second.

The Cats knotted it at 6-6 with four fourth inning runs and scored five times in the sixth to go in front by 11-6.

Pete Van Horne homered, then Steve Powers — who had homered in the second — doubled, Bill Simpson walked, Woodside and Pay O'Sullivan doubled and Dave Stegman tripled.

But the Miners, getting a two-run double from Villarreal, rallied for four in the bottom of the seventh to make it 11-10.

A bases-loaded walk to Mike Gatlin gave UA a 12-10 cushion in the eighth, but UTEP scored once in the bottom of that inning and Art Bravo's RBI single in the last of the ninth — with two out — tied it at 12-12.

But the Cats averted disaster in the 11th when, with two

out, Van Horne doubled, Powers and Simpson walked and Woodside slashed his three-run double to left-center.

Stegman stole second in the fifth inning, his 30th of the season. That gave him a school record, surpassing the 29 by Russ Gragg (1955) and Hugh McMullan (1952).

Powers came on as the third UA pitcher to pick up his 11th win against two losses. He struck out eight in five innings of relief.

UA ran through five UTEP hurlers with a 20-hit attack, the loss being pinned on Roy Stringer. It was Stringer who last year handed UA one of its losses in the 58-6 campaign.

Reds draw Blanks on

